

1949 (Technical Report No. 102-AC-49/15-100), which stated, in part:

"The most numerous reports indicate daytime observation of metallic disc-like objects roughly in diameter ten times their thickness.³² Some suggest the cross-section is assymetrical and rather like a turtle shell. Reports agree that the objects are capable of high acceleration and velocity. They are often sighted in groups, sometimes in formation."³³

Accurate models of flying saucers could be, and have been, made from these detailed descriptions.

LESSONS: The physical configuration of UFO as flying disks of a 10-to-1 diameter-to-thickness ratio were known long ago. In fact, NICAP published a very good and detailed study on UFO which included a detailed chart of UFO configuration types and comparative configurations with known aircraft.³⁴

UFO Propulsion System Described! (Fall of 1950)

In the Fall of 1950, Wilbert Brockhouse Smith, mentioned earlier in this treatise as the head of the Canadian PROJECT MAGNET investigation of UFO, gave very persuasive evidence of the use of magnetic fields for UFO propulsion, based on the available descriptions from eyewitnesses. Because his theory explains so many physical characteristics observable by intercepting pilots, I will quote him verbatim and at length:

³² Hall, Richard H. (Editor), The UFO Evidence, 1964, The National Investigations Committee on Aerial Phenomena (NICAP), Washington, DC, page 143; Keyhoe, Donald E. (Major, USMC-Retired), Flying Saucers from Outer Space, 1953, Henry Holt and Company, NY, page 138; Keyhoe, Donald E. (Major, USMC-Retired), Flying Saucers: Top Secret, 1960, G. P. Putnam's Sons, NY, page 157.

³³ Keyhoe, Donald E. (Major, USMC-Retired), Flying Saucers from Outer Space, 1953, Henry Holt and Company, NY, page 138.

³⁴ Hall, Richard H. (Editor), The UFO Evidence, 1964, The National Investigations Committee on Aerial Phenomena (NICAP), Washington, DC, pages 143 - 156.

"...our experiments indicate that the true discs, which are probably launched from large parent ships, utilize magnetic fields of force. And it's possible that the parent ships also use the same source of power...

"Certainly the theory's been ridiculed...So were plans for the aeroplane, the helicopter, jets, the A bomb - practically all our modern developments. I'd have doubted it myself before our experiments.

"...We've gone back to the fundamentals of electromagnetism and examined all the old laws. We know now it is possible to create current by a collapse of the earth's magnetic field. Eventually, I think, we can achieve enough current to power a flying disc. And we plan to build such a disc.

"...These investigations appear to point the way to a new technology in magnetics, and if the initial conclusions are correct they offer a ready-made explanation for many of the striking features which have been reported in connection with the sightings of flying saucers.

"The basic premise is that it is possible to produce a magnetic 'sink' within the earth's field; that is, a region into which the magnetic flux will flow at a controlled rate, giving up some of its potential energy in the process. Such a 'sink' would have many interesting properties, such as the following:

"1. Electrical power could be obtained from the collapse of the earth's magnetic field into the 'sink.'

"2. Powerful reaction forces could be developed in a conducting ring surrounding the sink and offset from it, sufficient to support a suitably designed ship and to propel it.

"3. If the rate of flow of magnetic flux is modulated, the resulting magnetic disturbances could be used for communication purposes.

"It is curious to note that most of the descriptions of flying saucers are in accordance with the design which would be necessary to exploit the properties of a magnetic sink. For example, the saucers are described as consisting of a large circular disc, with a small central cabin. In this case, the sink would be located in the upper central part of the cabin. The collapsing field in cutting through the surrounding metallic ring would induce in it an electric current which would react with the magnetic field which induced it, producing a force that would have a substantial vertical component. Support and propulsion of the ship would then be a combination of this resultant force, the airfoil action of the disc, and the interaction between eddy currents induced in the disc by its rotation and the main fields.

"Rotation of the disc may be either deliberate, for the induction of eddy currents, or may be incidentally caused by the electron drag of the very large current circulating around the disc. In any case, there is good observational evidence that the disc appears to rotate.

"Since the lift on the saucer will be proportionate to the product of the earth's magnetic field and the field produced by the current induced in the disc, it follows that when the saucer is accelerating upwards a greater force is required, and hence a greater circulating current.

"If the circulating current is sufficiently large and the cooling of the disc is inadequate, it may become red or even white hot, which is in line with several reported observations. Also, under certain conditions of operation, a very high voltage may be built up between the center and the rim of the disc, which could result in a corona discharge through the surrounding air, if the saucer were at a sufficiently high altitude. Such a discharge would resemble the Northern Lights but would be very much more intense. This also seems to be confirmed by observations.

"Navigation of such a flying saucer would be a very complex process indeed. In the first place, the earth's magnetic field makes all sorts of angles with the horizontal, depending upon geographical latitude and peculiar local conditions. Thus the direction of the force which results from the interaction of the earth's field and the field of the disc may be in almost any direction.

"Furthermore, the tilt of the saucer to get the reaction force in the wanted direction most probably will result in aerodynamic forces in some other direction. Navigation therefore will resolve into a determination of the field direction, comparison with the direction in which it is desired to move, and analysis of the aerodynamic forces which would result from such a motion - and, finally, a suitable correction in the initial tilt of the saucer and flow of magnetic flux.

"It is doubtful if a human pilot could manage to do all this at the speed which would be necessary to maneuver a saucer at the speeds and through the intricate motions which have been observed. It is therefore highly probable that the saucer control systems are semi- if not fully automatic. There are many reports of saucers hovering in one spot for some time. For a saucer designed to operate as described, this would probably be its easiest maneuver. It would be necessary merely to adjust the flux flow and the tilt until the resultant force exactly balanced the weight of the saucer. There would be little or no aerodynamic problem in this case.

"There is no indication that the accelerations to which a saucer crew would be subjected would be any different from the accelerations experienced in any other type of aircraft going through the same maneuvers. Those authorities who have been consulted say that even Einstein's Unified Field Theory does not indicate that gravity can be neutralized or the inertia of matter overcome. Where saucers have been observed to execute close turns

and other maneuvers which would result in large accelerations, it is most probable that such saucers are remotely controlled and do not contain living matter as we know it.

"...Most of the effects are caused by the disc's rotation, though sometimes a corona discharge is the cause. In the first place, probably many discs aren't seen at all, especially at night. If they're not heating up from rotation, and there's no corona discharge, you wouldn't see one unless it was caught in a searchlight beam or you saw its metal surface shining in the moonlight.

"...Now let's assume a rotating ring begins to speed up, so that it overheats from its movement through the magnetic field. At first, out of the darkness, you'd see a pale pink - if the speed-up was not too rapid. Then the color would brighten to red, orange-red, through yellow to the glow of white-hot metal. If you slowly heat any metal you'll see the same changes...

"Now if the ring's rotation was very swiftly accelerated, the human eye couldn't catch the rapid changes. It would go from red to white too quickly. The same holds true when the rotation is reduced. If the slowing is gradual, you'll see the various stages as the saucer turns yellow, orange, red, pink, and finally becomes dark. But if the rotation were abruptly slowed or stopped, the cooling effect of the air, especially at high speed, would be very swift. You could get the impression that the light had actually been turned off.

"...Under certain atmospheric conditions you'll get the Northern Light colors. At different heights a certain shade would predominate. For instance, at relatively low altitudes, any corona discharge would be very short in length and you'd see more of a blue-white color. Somewhat higher, it would be green, or bluish green. Higher still, you might see all the normal corona colors - red, yellow, blue, and green.

"If the ring were overheating, could you still see a corona

discharge?...

"Ordinarily, a bright red or white glow would nullify it. But if the rotation speed was only moderate, you might get a reddish color tinged with blue. Higher up, you'd be more likely to see a red shade, from heating, tinged with green or bluish green. It would most likely be a rather hazy effect instead of precise colors. In the majority of cases, however, you could expect just the red-orange-white range, and the reports bear that out...

"It explains the daytime variations, too...It's fairly clear, from the reports, that the discs are made of some silvery-colored metal. In sunshine they gleam like conventional aircraft. But there are color changes in daytime, when the saucers maneuver or suddenly speed up. Many of them have been described as turning red or getting white-hot - also the reverse. However, in bright sunlight it's harder to detect the changes - and to recognize the disc shape, too...

"There is an area of possible danger...With a disc 100 feet in diameter, for instance, there will be two fairly large fields of magnetic force around it while it's in operation. If it were to fly low over this city - let's say at 500 feet - eddy currents would be induced in power lines and metal surfaces. It could blow fuses, perhaps even burn out wires. The danger zone might even be larger; possibly it would extend for a thousand feet. I believe it's the main reason discs have avoided flying low over inhabited areas.

"...if a pilot did fly into a region where a magnetic field was collapsing, it would produce eddy currents in his plane.

"At a moderate distance it would merely throw off his direction finder and compass. If he were fairly close, it could affect his ignition and set up strong vibrations in his plane. It might even cause a fire. But the plane would have to be well inside the danger zone.

"Could the vibrations cause a plane to disintegrate?...

"Possibly...But it would have to be extremely close with a 100-foot disc. A larger one, rotating at high speed, would have a greater danger zone, of course.

"...On a sunny day a disc could be bright red from rotation, but seen close to the sun it would appear as just a brilliant object. Also, any corona effect would be much dimmer in daylight. The farther from the sun, the more of the true color you'd see.

"On a cloudy day, people have seen the actual color changes. At first a disc which isn't heating up will look silvery - or gray, on a very dark day. Then increased rotation will give it a reddish tint, and on through orange to white. And of course the reverse, as rotation decreases.

"...oscillation would be caused by the disc's adjustment to changing magnetic fields. In a formation, you'll sometimes see individual saucers wobble in succession as they pass through different fields...

"A few people have reported hearing them...But most sightings, I think, have been at altitudes higher than witnesses thought - so high that you wouldn't hear anything. In two or three cases, when discs passed overhead at a moderately low altitude, people have said they heard a swish. And of course if you were very near a saucer on the ground, or if it was hovering close to the earth, you'd undoubtedly hear a humming sound from the rotation. That is, unless other sounds - like a train passing by - drowned it out."³⁵

Here is a fairly complete "layman's description" of the power source and propulsion system of the flying saucer! It lay buried in the library for decades, but now it gives a lead on where to find the information on

³⁵ Keyhoe, Donald E. (Major, USMC-Retired), Flying Saucers from Outer Space, 1953, Henry Holt and Company, NY, pages 131 - 144.

the subject. Now, just imagine how much hob a rip-snorting thunderstorm could do to such a magnetically propelled vehicle, and remember that the previously described Roswell crash occurred during a very severe thunderstorm! Also, the prospects of duplicating UFO performance in a manmade vehicle would have been impossible until the development of modern computer technology. Remember, also, that the Roswell wreckage included much evidence of fiberoptics, possibly indicating that the strong magnetic fields generated by the power system preclude the use of regular control circuitry and computer wiring. The Canadian project did do some laboratory tests with a rotating disc in late 1951, but the work was classified and it is unlikely that any results were ever published.³⁶ It would be of inestimable value to be able to obtain copies of the internal, Canadian Government reports of these tests, including the complete and detailed scientific explanations of the theory, the detailed designs of the test vehicles and the detailed results of the tests! Consider, also, how this same technology could possibly be applied to revolutionize the stationary power generation industry: we are speaking here of a possible non-polluting source of essentially inexhaustible electrical energy! Also consider what effects this unique power/propulsion system may have on radars trying to track it.

LESSONS: Enough data existed, even back then, to understand at least the theory of how the UFO operated. Could the "old laws" examined have had anything to do with the work of Tesla, who is known to have done some very strange things involving ground-based power generation that had effects similar to what we know of UFO phenomena? The only reason we've been fooling around with expensive and wasteful, "reaction engine" vehicles for so long probably is because we have been heretofore unable to duplicate the power and control systems, and probably the materials used in the manufacture of a "saucer" ship. When you look at all the areas that this type of electromagnetic "sink" power system will affect, once it becomes

³⁶ Keyhoe, Donald E. (Major, USMC-Retired), Flying Saucers from Outer Space, 1953, Henry Holt and Company, NY, page 144.

commercially viable, it is "Katy bar the door": such a revolution may be delayed in order to reduce the economic impact on the society! It may also explain some strange anomalies which have been observed by those trying to track UFO on radar. In addition, Wilbert Brockhouse Smith will undoubtedly go down in history alongside Sir Isaac Newton, Albert Einstein, et al.

The Washington National Sightings (19 & 26 Jul 1952)

On 19 and 26 Jul 1952, flying saucers swarmed through the airspace of Washington, DC, in what became known as the Washington National Sightings, after Washington National Airport, on whose radar they first appeared. This series of sightings all involved multiple witnesses and multiple radar trackings. Radars at Washington National, Bolling AFB, and Andrews AFB all tracked the UFO, some flying in formation and others, alone. Speeds ranged from hovering to over 8,000 miles per hour. On several occasions, more than one of these radars (including both ground and airborne radars) were tracking the same objects, which does not occur with temperature inversion targets. Intercepts were tried, but without notable success: the targets were real, but they were of such superior performance that they could avoid the interceptors at will. The Air Force tried to brush them off as temperature inversions, but the inversions on the nights in question were no more than a degree and a half Fahrenheit, or about one-sixth the amount required to produce even the most rudimentary false targets.³⁷

LESSONS: Even if you disregard the Roswell Recovery, the Washington National Sightings clearly demonstrate the reality of technologically superior aerospace vehicles, and disproves claims of "temperature inversion" as the cause for otherwise unexplainable sightings.

Limited Declassification of UFO Wreckage to Civilians (1952 - 1954)

At several points along the way, consideration was given to the

³⁷ Keyhoe, Donald E. (Major, USMC-Retired), Flying Saucers from Outer Space, 1953, Henry Holt and Company, NY, pages 62 - 89; Randle, Kevin D. (Captain, USAF-Retired), The UFO Casebook, 1989, Warner Books, Inc., NY, pages 69 - 74.

possibility of "coming clean" about the entire UFO situation. According to all reports, at least two of these reassessments included the limited declassification of the vehicle remains to a carefully selected group of civilians, so that their reactions could be appraised.³⁸ It was from a reassessment such as this that sporadic "leaks", over the years, may have come to pass: a Joseph Rohrer, President of Pike's Peak Broadcasting Company in Pueblo, Colorado claimed to have been allowed (prior to 19 Aug 1952) into one of several disks which the US Government had in its possession.³⁹ Another such leak, from a later and similar experiment, revealed more about who was being chosen for these "reaction" tests: a Gerald Light of Los Angeles was taken to Muroc (Edwards Air Force Base) sometime just prior to 16 Apr 1954, along with Franklin Allen of the Hearst papers, Edwin Nourse of the Brookings Institute, and Catholic Bishop (later Cardinal) James F. A. McIntyre of Los Angeles. Light claimed to have been at Muroc for some 48 hours, and to have seen no less than five distinct types of UFO under investigation by US Air Force personnel, supposedly with the permission of their builders!⁴⁰ It is both astounding and unfortunate that none of the early civilian UFO investigators ever followed up on these leads! By the time later investigators rediscovered the early leaks and picked up the trail, all the principal witnesses had long since expired.

LESSONS: There were many "leaks" in the supposedly "air tight" security surrounding governmental UFO investigations. These glimpses "behind the curtain" indicate far more knowledge than the government has ever admitted in public. It also argues that there were some very serious internal

³⁸ Berlitz, Charles and Moore, William L., The Roswell Incident: The Classic Study of UFO Contact, originally published in 1980, reprinted (paperback) in 1988, Berkley Books, NY, pages 131 - 135.

³⁹ Keyhoe, Donald E. (Major, USMC-Retired), Flying Saucers from Outer Space, 1953, Henry Holt and Company, NY, pages 111 - 112.

⁴⁰ Berlitz, Charles and Moore, William L., The Roswell Incident: The Classic Study of UFO Contact, originally published in 1980, reprinted (paperback) in 1988, Berkley Books, NY, pages 131 - 135.

disputes about "going public" about UFO matters, during which those favoring continued secrecy managed to "load the dice" in their favor by insisting on "cold" disclosure: none of these witnesses underwent any careful preparation for the revelations which they received, so it is no wonder that severe reactions occurred, which would only reinforce the hand of what NICAP members used to call the "Silence Group" in government circles. It is unfortunate that this is also an indictment of the apathy and indolence of the early civilian UFO investigatory organizations, in that these "golden opportunities" were never adequately pursued! I ardently hope and pray that this last lesson has thoroughly "sunk in" to the modern civilian investigators.

The CIA Report of UFO Size and Flight Characteristics (14 Aug 1952)

A CIA Special Study on UFO conducted regular briefings in the early 1950s. The briefing document of 14 Aug 1952, classified "secret" at the time, revealed that some of these vehicles were obviously remote control devices only 2 or 3 feet across, with most of the ones thought to be "manned" vehicles estimated at 100 feet in diameter, but with a whole range of sizes up to as much as 1,000 feet in diameter. Velocities ranged from hovering up to 18,000 miles per hour, and altitudes from ground level on up to cislunar space. In high speed maneuvers, the "manned" craft exhibited 20g turns.⁴¹ Top speeds, at altitudes as low as 18,000 feet, were solidly pegged by radar tracking of visually confirmed UFO at a minimum of 9,000 miles per hour!⁴² This CIA briefing was apparently prepared before the data from the Pan American-Norfolk (Nash-Fortenberry) Sighting (14 Jul 1952) had been thoroughly analyzed: a formation of apparently manned UFO traversed a distance of some 50 miles in no more than 15 seconds, at an altitude of approximately 2,000 feet, executing a violent 150 degree turn

⁴¹ Good, Timothy, Above Top Secret: The Worldwide UFO Cover-up, 1989, Quill Books, NY, pages 331 - 332.

⁴² Keyhoe, Donald E. (Major, USMC-Retired), Flying Saucers from Outer Space, 1953, Henry Holt and Company, NY, pages 161 - 165.